

Variables Used in Quantitative Analysis.

Category	Variable	Description	Scale or Value Range
Demographics	Age	Self-reported age group	Young; Middle-aged; Elderly
	Gender	Self-identified gender	Female; Male; Non-binary
	Education	Highest level of formal education completed	High school or below; Undergraduate; Postgraduate
Security Experience	Field	Primary field of work or study	Computer-related; Non-computer-related
	CreateTime	Time since last account creation	1 (last week) to 5 (more than 6 months ago)
	Frequency	Frequency of encountering PSMs when creating passwords	1 (never) to 5 (always)
	Ignore	Whether the participant has ever disregarded a PSM's suggestion	No; Yes
	InitialTrust	Self-reported trust in PSMs prior to the study	1 (not at all) to 5 (very much)
Task Performance	Training	Whether the participant received formal password security training	No; Yes
	InitialJudgment	Participants' initial judgments before knowing any ratings	1 (weak) to 3 (strong)
	ConfidenceLevel	Confidence in their initial judgments	1 (least confident) to 5 (most confident)
Dependent Variables	ChangeOrNot	Whether the participant changed their initial judgments	No; Yes
	AgreeLevel	Participants' agreement with the PSMs "strong" ratings	1 (disagree) to 3 (agree)
	SecondTrust	Whether the misalignment affected their trust in PSMs	No; Yes